

DELFT UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

Private Set Intersection on Intervals

Honours Program Research Proposal

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1 Introduction

Collaboration has always been the key to rapid and successful technology development in all fields. However, exposing unnecessary information to the party with which you are working increases the risk that malicious individuals might get ahold of that data.

For example, let there be a private hospital and the government of the country in which the hospital is. Now let's say the hospital wants to check which of their patients have already been vaccinated. In order to perform this statistic, they need to compute the intersection between the list of patients that they have and the national vaccination registry. Here comes the security related part: the hospital must protect its patient's data, meaning it can't let the government know which patients it has, while the government also needs to protect the data inside the national vaccination registry.

This is where the Private Set Intersection technique comes into play: Both parties "blind" the elements in their sets and then compute the intersection on that "blinded" data. This is a unifying principle across all PSI protocols, as it guarantees that no additional information is revealed to either side.

2 Research Questions

RQ 1. What are some of the use cases for an "interval-based" PSI algorithm?

RQ 2. What is the time complexity of such algorithms compared to their "single-item" implementations?

RQ 3. Is it feasible to deploy aforementioned algorithms in real world scenarios?

3 Related Work

Private Set Intersection is a very well researched domain, proven by the fact that only in this year has already seen at least 600 publications (verified easily by querying research databases such as ACM Digital Library). Throughout this extensive research, implementations of PSI have been split into two different categories: traditional and delegated.

3.1 Traditional PSI

Traditional PSI is defined by the fact that the only parties involved in the computation of intersections are the client and the server.

3.2 Delegated PSI

4 Methodology

5 Timeline